

SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK
COUNTY OF BRONX

-----X
DANTE STEPHENS,

Plaintiff,

-against-

CITY OF NEW YORK, JONATHAN VASQUEZ and JOHN
OR JANE DOES, "1-10", Individually and officially in their
capacities as police officers,

Defendants.
-----X

Index No.:

Date Purchased:

SUMMONS

Plaintiff designates Bronx
County as the place of trial.

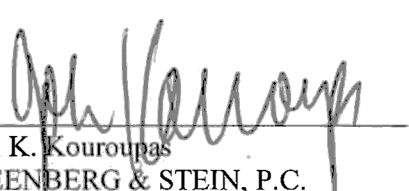
The basis of venue is:
Where the incident occurred

Plaintiff resides at:
4715 Richardson Street Apt. 1
Bronx, NY 10470

To the above-named Defendant(s):

You are hereby summoned to answer the complaint in this action and to serve a copy of your answer, or if the complaint is not served with this summons, to serve a notice of appearance, on the Plaintiff's Attorney(s) within 20 days after the service of this summons, exclusive of the day of service (or within 30 days after the service is complete if this summons is not personally delivered to you within the State of New York); and in case of your failure to appear or answer, judgment will be taken against you by default for the relief demanded in the complaint.

Dated: New York, New York
January 03, 2023



John K. Kouroupas
GREENBERG & STEIN, P.C.
Attorney for Plaintiff
DANTE STEPHENS
420 Lexington Avenue, Suite 2450
New York, New York 10170
(212) 681-2535
Our File No. 7140

TO:

CITY OF NEW YORK
100 Church Street
New York, NY 10007

JONATHAN VASQUEZ
POLICE OFFICER SHIELD NO.: 11731
4111 Laconia Ave,
Bronx, NY 10466

SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK
COUNTY OF BRONX

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DANTE STEPHENS,

Plaintiff,

-against-

CITY OF NEW YORK, JONATHAN VASQUEZ and JOHN
OR JANE DOES, "1-10", Individually and officially in their
capacities as police officers

Defendants.
-----X

VERIFIED COMPLAINT

Index No.:

Date Purchased:

Plaintiff, DANTE STEPHENS by his attorneys, GREENBERG & STEIN, P.C., as and for his complaint against the Defendants, CITY OF NEW YORK, JONATHAN VASQUEZ and JOHN or JANE DOES "1-10", individually and officially in their capacities as police officers, allege and state as follows:

PRELIMINARY STATEMENT

1. This is a civil rights action, in which Plaintiff seeks relief, vis-à-vis 42 U.S.C. §§ 1981, 1983, 1985, 1986 and 1988, the laws of the State of New York, in addition to the self- executing clauses or implied private causes of action within the constitution of the State of New York, for the violations of their civil rights and the deprivations to his liberties, as enumerated and promulgated by the Fourth and Fourteenth Amendments to the Constitution of the United States, as well as the laws and constitution of the State of New York.

2. The following claims arose on or about February 06, 2020, when Defendants, acting under color of state law, unlawfully stopped, questioned, searched, assaulted, battered, arrested, and detained Plaintiff without a valid judicially authorized arrest warrant, reasonable suspicion, probable cause, or any other legal justification to do so.

3. The above referenced acts caused Plaintiff to be deprived of his liberty in violation of their rights to be free from unreasonable searches and seizures and to be afforded Equal Protection under the law.

4. Plaintiff seeks monetary damages (compensatory and punitive) against Defendants, an award of

costs and attorney's fees, with all interest then accrued, together with such other and further relief as this Court may deem just and proper.

JURISDICTION

5. This action arises under the First, Fourth, Fifth and Fourteenth Amendments to the United States Constitution, under 42 U.S.C. §§ 1981, 1983, 1985, 1986 and 1988 and pursuant to the Laws and constitution of the State of New York.

6. The jurisdiction of this Court is predicated upon 28 U.S.C. §§ 1331, 1343(a)(3) and (4), 1367(a) and the doctrine of supplemental jurisdiction.

VENUE

7. Venue is laid within the Supreme Court State of New York, County of Bronx in that Defendant City of New York is located within and a substantial part of the events giving rise to the claims occurred within the boundaries of the Supreme Court.

PARTIES

8. At all relevant times, Plaintiff, **DANTE STEPHENS** ("Mr. Stephens"), is an adult African American male, residing in Bronx County, New York.

9. At all relevant times, Defendant, **CITY OF NEW YORK** ("City"), is a municipal corporation organized under the laws of the State of New York.

10. At all relevant times herein, the New York Police Department ("NYPD") is a wholly owned subsidiary, which is further wholly operated, managed, maintained, and controlled by Defendant City.

11. At all relevant times herein, Defendant City, acting through its NYPD, was responsible for the policy, practice, supervision, implementation, and conduct of all NYPD matters and was responsible for the appointment, screening, hiring, training, supervision, discipline, retention, and conduct of all NYPD personnel,

including police officers, detectives, investigators, sergeants, lieutenants, and other supervisory officers or officials, as well as the individually named Defendants herein.

12. At all relevant times herein, Defendant City, was responsible for enforcing the rules or regulations of the NYPD, and for ensuring that the NYPD personnel obey the laws and constitutions of the United States and the State of New York.

13. At all relevant times herein, Defendants, **JOHN OR JANE DOES, "1-10"**, were police officers, detectives, supervisors, policymakers or officials employed by the NYPD and or City of New York. At this time, Plaintiff did not know the true names or tax registry numbers of Defendants, **JOHN OR JANE DOES, "1-10"**, as such knowledge is within the exclusive possession of Defendants. The names, **JOHN OR JANE DOES, "1-10"**, are fictitious and are meant as placeholders for the Police Officers who falsely arrested and subjected Plaintiff to excessive force.

14. At all relevant times herein, Defendants, **JONATHAN VASQUEZ** and **JOHN OR JANE DOES, "1-10"**, were acting as agents, servants and employees of the City of New York, or the NYPD. Defendants **JONATHAN VASQUEZ** and **JOHN OR JANE DOES, "1-10"**, are being sued in their individual and official capacities.

15. At all relevant times herein, Defendants were acting under color of state law, to wit, under color of the statutes, ordinances, regulations, policies, customs, and usages of the City of New York or State of New York.

16. At all times relevant hereto, Defendant City, acting through the New York City Police Department ("NYPD"), was responsible for the policy, practice, supervision, implementation, and conduct of all NYPD matters and was responsible for the appointment, training, supervision, discipline and retention and conduct of all NYPD personnel, including police officers, detectives and supervisory officers as well as the individually named Defendants herein.

17. At all times here relevant, Defendant City was responsible for enforcing the rules of the

NYPD, and for ensuring that the NYPD personnel obey the laws of the United States and of the State of New York.

FACTUAL CHARGES

18. On, or about, February 06, 2020, at approximately 2:30 p.m., Plaintiff, DANTE STEPHENS, was enjoying some leisure time in the vicinity of 4111 Laconia Avenue, County of Bronx, State of New York, when defendants, including, **JONATHAN VASQUEZ** and **JOHN OR JANE DOES, "1-10"**, illegally searched, seized, detained and arrested him.

19. Plaintiff had not committed any crimes or violations of law, nor had there been any indication of such, and nor had they been accused of such by any identified civilian witnesses.

20. On said date and time, Plaintiff **STEPHENS**, was enjoying some leisure time in the vicinity of 4111 Laconia Avenue, County of Bronx, State of New York, when Defendants, including **JONATHAN VASQUEZ** and **JOHN OR JANE DOES, "1-10"**, aggressively approached, assaulted, questioned, and illegally detained Plaintiff **STEPHENS**.

21. Defendants, including **JONATHAN VASQUEZ** and **JOHN OR JANE DOES, "1-10"**, then yelled and continued to aim their weapons at Plaintiff **STEPHENS**, and, causing Plaintiff **STEPHENS** to experience severe humiliation, degradation, and the loss of his dignity as well as the shock of being confronted with a weapon.

22. Defendants, including **JONATHAN VASQUEZ** and **JOHN OR JANE DOES, "1-10"**, then accused Plaintiff **STEPHENS** of a criminal offense before investigating whether or not he could be positively identified as the individual they were looking for.

23. Due to the lack of probable cause, the aforementioned conduct by Defendants, including **JONATHAN VASQUEZ** and **JOHN OR JANE DOES, "1-10"**, constitute the completed torts of Assault and Battery.

24. Plaintiff **STEPHENS** was then arrested again because Federal agents arrested Plaintiff based on the NYPD's false gun charges. Plaintiff was maliciously prosecuted because of the charges that the NYPD started, and the Federal Government enhanced. Said charges were also dismissed. Plaintiff **STEPHENS** was charged twice for the same crime due to the NYPD's false statements.

25. Defendants, including **JONATHAN VASQUEZ** and **JOHN OR JANE DOES, "1-10"**, never observed Plaintiff committing any crime or violation of the law, or any act that could reasonably be suspected as such.

26. Defendants, including **JONATHAN VASQUEZ** and **JOHN OR JANE DOES, "1-10"**, had no probable cause or reasonable suspicion to justify their seizure, search, questioning, detention, or arrest of Plaintiff, as defendants did not possess any credible evidence that would lead a reasonable officer to believe that Plaintiff had committed any crime or violation of the law.

27. Defendants, including **JONATHAN VASQUEZ** and **JOHN OR JANE DOES, "1-10"**, engaged in a gross deviation from acceptable police conduct and other conduct undertaken in bad faith.

28. Plaintiff asserts that Defendants, including **JONATHAN VASQUEZ** and **JOHN OR JANE DOES, "1-10"**, falsely arrested Plaintiff **STEPHENS** and wrongfully detained Plaintiff altogether with the full knowledge that the Plaintiff had not actually committed any crimes or violations of the law.

29. As a result, Plaintiff was caused to be unlawfully, involuntarily, and continuously detained by defendants, including **JONATHAN VASQUEZ** and **JOHN OR JANE DOES, "1-10"**, until his release from physical custody when said defendants ended their illegal search.

30. At all times relevant hereto, Defendants, including **JONATHAN VASQUEZ** and **JOHN OR JANE DOES, "1-10"**, were involved in the decision to seize, search, detain, and arrest Plaintiff without reasonable suspicion or probable cause, or failed to intervene when they observed others doing do in the absence of any reasonable suspicion or probable cause.

31. At all times relevant hereto, Defendants, including **JONATHAN VASQUEZ** and **JOHN OR JANE DOES, "1-10"**, subjected Plaintiff to excessive force, or failed to intervene when they observed others

subjecting Plaintiff to excessive force.

32. Defendants, including **JONATHAN VASQUEZ** and **JOHN OR JANE DOES, "1-10"**, engaged in a conspiracy to falsely arrest Plaintiff **STEPHENS** by personally conferring with each other regarding the fabrication of the aforementioned non-existent evidence, the suppression of exculpatory evidence, as well as the manner and means by which said fabrications could be used to deprive Plaintiff of his liberty and violate his civil rights.

33. Plaintiff assert that Defendants, including **JONATHAN VASQUEZ** and **JOHN OR JANE DOES, "1-10"**, illegally approached, seized, searched, and then falsely arrested him, due to their discriminatory prejudices against African Americans, their intent to use the instant arrest as leverage against Plaintiff or relatives of Plaintiff, so that he would provide defendants with information regarding other crimes or criminal suspects, their desires to fulfill an unconstitutional arrest quota, and to benefit from increased overtime compensation.

34. Defendants, including **JONATHAN VASQUEZ** and **JOHN OR JANE DOES, "1-10"**, arrested Plaintiff, because of their racially discriminatory beliefs, which compelled defendants to equate to Plaintiff's ethnic or national origin to criminal guilt or criminal knowledge.

35. Defendants, including **JONATHAN VASQUEZ** and **JOHN OR JANE DOES, "1-10"**, perpetrated multiple overt acts in furtherance of their obviously discriminatory inclinations, namely the complained-of stop, searches, assaults, batteries, seizure, arrest, and detention of Plaintiff, even after they were unable to discover any evidence to justify such conduct.

36. Defendants, including **JONATHAN VASQUEZ** and **JOHN OR JANE DOES, "1-10"**, unlawfully stopped, questioned, searched, seized, arrested, and detained plaintiff, due to Defendants' perception or consideration of Plaintiff's ethnicity or national origin.

37. Defendants, including **JONATHAN VASQUEZ** and **JOHN OR JANE DOES, "1-10"**, possessed no valid reason to stop, question, search, or arrest Plaintiff, which gives rise to the strong inference that such conduct resulted from defendants' unjust motivations or proclivities.

38. Defendants, including **JONATHAN VASQUEZ** and **JOHN OR JANE DOES, "1-10"**,

subjected Plaintiff to disparate treatment compared to other individuals similarly situated, because defendants did not stop, seize, search, detain, arrest, or accuse any white individuals who had engaged in activity identical to the kind that resulted in Plaintiff's illegal search and seizure, namely being lawfully present and sleeping in their home.

39. Plaintiff assert that the Defendants, including **JONATHAN VASQUEZ** and **JOHN OR JANE DOES, "1-10"**, who violated Plaintiff's civil rights, are part of a larger pattern and practice of similar misconduct, which is so widespread, pervasive and consistent throughout the NYPD and the City of New York that the commission such constitutionally violative behavior has become tantamount to an official policy or custom within the NYPD and City of New York or, at the very least, conclusive evidence that the City, NYPD, have either tacitly approved of such egregious wrongdoings or that they have become deliberately indifferent to the civil rights of those who may come into contact with their police officers.

40. The identities of Defendants, including **JONATHAN VASQUEZ** and **JOHN OR JANE DOES, "1-10"**, are unknown at this present time. However, these Defendants were participated in the false arrest, unlawful search, seizure, and detention of Plaintiff. The identities of Defendants, including **JONATHAN VASQUEZ** and **JOHN OR JANE DOES, "1-10"**, are known exclusively to the Defendants.

41. The individually named defendants herein, as well as other officers serving in the employ of the NYPD and City of New York, have blatantly, shamelessly, consistently, and repeatedly engaged in conduct violative of the civil rights guaranteed and protected by Constitution of the United States, in addition to the laws and constitution of the State of New York, all without incurring any ramifications for such misconduct and, ostensibly, with the full and complete blessing of the NYPD and the City of New York, in addition to their respective policymakers and supervisors.

42. Upon information and belief, the NYPD and City of New York, and their respective policymakers, officials or supervisors have imposed, tacitly approved, or acquiesced to policies, customs, or patterns and practices within the NYPD that resulted in Plaintiff's arrests without probable cause.

43. Upon information and belief, the NYPD and City of New York, and their respective policymakers

or supervisors have failed to provide adequate training regarding the identification of probable cause, reasonable suspicion or the appropriate amount of force to be used.

44. Defendants' actions, which occurred without even the semblance of probable cause, were so blatantly violative of his civil rights that the tacit approval of identical or similar acts by the policymakers or supervisors of the NYPD and the City of New York, as well as their deliberate indifference towards the rights of any individuals who may come into contact with Defendants, should be inferred, because such flagrant deprivations of constitutionally protected rights could not and would not occur without the tacit approval or deliberate indifference regarding the commission of such violations by the policymakers or supervisors of the NYPD and City of New York.

45. Upon information and belief, further details and facts, relating to the unlawful policies, customs or patterns and practices of the NYPD, City of New York and their respective policymakers, supervisors, police officers or employees, will become known after the completion of discovery, as such information is presently within the exclusive possession of Defendants, the NYPD and City of New York.

46. Upon information and belief, the personnel files, records and disciplinary histories of the officer Defendants will reveal a history of Constitutional violations indicative of Defendant City's knowledge that the individual officer Defendants were unfit for employment as NYPD officers, or for employment in general, and that the probability of the individually named Defendants committing similar violations in the future was extremely high.

47. Upon information and belief, said personnel files, records and disciplinary histories will conclusively show that the City and NYPD were fully aware of Defendants' past constitutional violations, the unacceptably high probability for the recurrence of similar transgressions, the unreasonably dangerous situations that were likely to result from their hiring or retention, as well as their unsuitability for employment as law enforcement officers, or for employment in general, and that the NYPD and City of New York failed to engage in any preventive or corrective action intended to diminish the likelihood of recurrence for such violations, which is tantamount to the City's tacit approval of such misconduct or the City's deliberate indifference towards the civil

rights of those who may interact with its employees, including Defendants JONATHAN VASQUEZ, JOHN DOES 1-10.

48. Upon information and belief, the individually named Defendants have combined to be named as Defendants in numerous lawsuits that have accused them of committing violations similar or identical to those alleged herein, all of which have resulted no disciplinary or corrective action of any kind.

49. Upon information and belief, the NYPD and City of New York and have failed, or outright refused, to correct the individually named Defendants' predilections to engage in unconstitutional behavior or attempt to prevent the recurrence of such misconduct.

50. The aforementioned acts of Defendants, including JONATHAN VASQUEZ and JOHN OR JANE DOES, "1-10", directly or proximately resulted in the deprivation or violation of Plaintiff's civil rights, as guaranteed and protected by the Fourth and Fourteenth Amendments to the United States Constitution, as well as the laws and Constitution of the State of New York.

51. As a direct or proximate result of said acts, Plaintiff was caused to suffer the loss of their liberty, irreparable reputational harm, loss of earnings and potential earnings, physical injury, as well as severe and permanent emotional distress, including fear, embarrassment, humiliation, traumatization, frustration, extreme inconvenience and anxiety.

FIRST CAUSE OF ACTION

Unlawful Search & Seizure Under New York State Law

52. The above paragraphs are hereby incorporated by reference as though fully set forth.

53. Defendants subjected Plaintiff and his property to unreasonable searches and seizures without a valid warrant and without reasonable suspicion or probable cause do so.

54. Plaintiff were conscious and fully aware of the unreasonable searches and seizures to his person and property.

55. Plaintiff did not consent to the unreasonable searches and seizures to their person or property.

56. The unreasonable searches and seizures to Plaintiff's person and property was not otherwise privileged.

57. Accordingly, Defendants violated Plaintiff's right to be free from unreasonable searches and seizures, pursuant to Art. I, § 12, of the constitution of the State of New York and Art. II, § 8, of the New York Civil Rights Law.

58. Defendant City, as employer of the individual Defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoings under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

59. As a direct and proximate result of this unlawful conduct, Plaintiff sustained the damages hereinbefore alleged.

SECOND CAUSE OF ACTION

Unlawful Search & Seizure Under 42 U.S.C. § 1983 Against Individual Defendants

60. The above paragraphs are hereby incorporated by reference as though fully set forth.

61. Defendants subjected Plaintiff and his property to unreasonable searches and seizures without a valid warrant and without reasonable suspicion or probable cause do so.

62. Plaintiff was conscious and fully aware of the unreasonable searches and seizures to his person and property.

63. Plaintiff did not consent to the unreasonable searches and seizures to his person or property.

64. The unreasonable searches and seizures to Plaintiff's person and property was not otherwise privileged.

65. Accordingly, defendants violated Plaintiff's right to be free from unreasonable searches and seizures, pursuant to the Fourth Amendment to the Constitution of the United States.

66. As a direct and proximate result of this unlawful conduct, Plaintiff sustained the damages hereinbefore alleged.

THIRD CAUSE OF ACTION

Negligent or Intentional Infliction of Emotional Distress Under New York State Law

67. The above paragraphs are hereby incorporated by reference as though fully set forth.
68. Defendants owed a duty of care to Plaintiff.
69. Defendants breached that duty of care.
70. As a result, Plaintiff were caused sustain emotional harm or distress.
71. The conduct of Defendants was extreme and outrageous.
72. Defendants' extreme and outrageous conduct was perpetrated with the intent to cause, or with disregard to a substantial probability of causing, severe emotional distress to Plaintiff.
73. Defendants' extreme and outrageous conduct is causally related to Plaintiff's injuries.
74. As a result, Plaintiff were caused to sustain extreme emotional distress.
75. Defendant City, as employer of the individual Defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.
76. As a direct and proximate result of this unlawful conduct, Plaintiff sustained the damages hereinbefore alleged.

FOURTH CAUSE OF ACTION

False Arrest & False Imprisonment Under New York State Law

77. The above paragraphs are hereby incorporated by reference as though fully set forth.
78. Defendants subjected Plaintiff to false arrest, false imprisonment, and deprivation of liberty without probable cause.
79. Plaintiff were conscious of their confinement.
80. Plaintiff did not consent to their confinement.
81. Plaintiff arrest and false imprisonment was not otherwise privileged.
82. Defendant City, as employer of the individual Defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

83. As a direct and proximate result of this unlawful conduct, Plaintiff sustained the damages hereinbefore alleged.

FIFTH CAUSE OF ACTION

False Arrest & False Imprisonment Under 42 U.S.C. § 1983 Against Individual Defendants

84. The above paragraphs are hereby incorporated by reference as though fully set forth.

85. The Defendants violated the Fourth and Fourteenth Amendments to the Constitution of the United States by wrongfully and illegally arresting, detaining and imprisoning Plaintiff.

86. The wrongful, unjustifiable, and unlawful apprehension, arrest, detention, and imprisonment of Plaintiff was carried out without a valid warrant, without Plaintiff's consent, and without probable cause or reasonable suspicion.

87. At all relevant times, Defendants acted forcibly in apprehending, arresting, and imprisoning Plaintiff.

88. As a direct and proximate result of this unlawful conduct, Plaintiff sustained the damages hereinbefore alleged.

SIXTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Assault & Battery Under New York State Law

89. The above paragraphs are hereby incorporated by reference as though fully set forth.

90. Defendants made Plaintiff fear for his physical well-being and safety and placed him in apprehension of immediate harmful or offensive touching.

91. Defendants engaged in and subjected Plaintiff to immediate harmful or offensive touching and battered them without their consent.

92. Defendant City, as employer of the individual Defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

93. As a direct and proximate result of this breach, Plaintiff sustained the damages hereinbefore

alleged.

SEVENTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Excessive Force Under 42 U.S.C. § 1983 Against Individual Defendants

94. The above paragraphs are hereby incorporated by reference as though fully set forth.

95. Defendants violated Plaintiff's rights, under the Fourth and Fourteenth Amendments, because they used unreasonable force without Plaintiff's consent.

96. Defendants engaged in and subjected Plaintiff to immediate harmful or offensive touching and battered them without their consent.

97. As a direct and proximate result of this breach, Plaintiff sustained the damages hereinbefore alleged.

98. As a direct and proximate result of this unlawful conduct, Plaintiff sustained the damages hereinbefore alleged.

EIGHTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Deprivation of Rights & Denial of Equal Protection of the Laws Under New York State law

99. The above paragraphs are hereby incorporated by reference as though fully set forth herein.

100. Plaintiff is a member of a racial or ethnic minority and protected class.

101. Defendants discriminated against Plaintiff on the basis of his race, color, national origin, ancestry, gender, religion, religious practice, age, disability or sexual orientation

102. Defendants also engaged in the selective treatment of Plaintiff, in comparison to others similarly situated.

103. Defendants' discriminatory treatment of Plaintiff was based on impermissible considerations, such as race, color, ethnicity, an intent to inhibit or punish Plaintiff for the exertion of their Constitutional rights, or a malicious or bad faith intent to injure Plaintiff.

104. Defendants applied facially neutral laws against Plaintiff in a discriminatory manner.

105. Defendants, motivated by discriminatory animus, applied facially neutral statutes with adverse effects against Plaintiff.

106. Defendants did not possess a rational basis, excuse, or justification for applying any laws or statutes against Plaintiff.

107. Accordingly, defendants violated Plaintiff rights, pursuant to Article I, § 11, of the New York State Constitution, Article VII, § 79-N, of the New York Civil Rights Law and § 296, 13, of the New York Human Rights Law.

108. Defendant City, as employer of the individual Defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

109. As a direct and proximate result of this unlawful conduct, Plaintiff sustained the damages hereinbefore alleged.

NINTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Deprivation of Rights & Denial of Equal Protection of the Laws Under 42 U.S.C.
§§ 1981 & 1983 Against Individual Defendants

110. The above paragraphs are hereby incorporated by reference as though fully set forth herein.

111. Plaintiff is a member of a racial or ethnic minority and protected class.

112. Defendants discriminated against Plaintiff on the basis of their race, color or ethnicity.

113. Defendants engaged in the selective treatment of Plaintiff in comparison to others similarly situated.

114. Defendants' selective treatment of Plaintiff was based on impermissible considerations, such as race, color, ethnicity, an intent to inhibit or punish Plaintiff for the exertion of their Constitutional rights, or malicious or bad faith intent to injure Plaintiff.

115. Defendants applied facially neutral laws against Plaintiff in a discriminatory manner.

116. Defendants, motivated by a discriminatory animus, applied facially neutral penal statutes with adverse effects against Plaintiff.

117. Defendants did not possess a rational basis, excuse or justification for applying any laws or statutes against Plaintiff.

118. Accordingly, defendants violated Plaintiff's rights, under the Fourteenth Amendment.

119. Defendant City, as employer of the individual Defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

120. As a direct and proximate result of this unlawful conduct, Plaintiff sustained the damages hereinbefore alleged.

TENTH CAUSE OF ACTION

**Conspiracy to Interfere with Civil Rights & Failure to Prevent the Conspiracy Under 42
U.S.C. §§ 1983, 1985 & 1986 Against Individual Defendants**

121. The above paragraphs are hereby incorporated by reference as though fully set forth herein.

122. Defendants engaged in a conspiracy against Plaintiff to deprive Plaintiff of their rights to engage in protected speech or activities, to be free from unreasonable searches and seizures, to be afforded a fair trial, to not be deprived of their liberty or property without due process of law, or of the privileges and immunities under the laws and constitutions of the United States and of the State of New York.

123. Defendants committed overt acts in furtherance of their conspiracy against Plaintiff.

124. As a result, Plaintiff sustained injuries to their persons, were deprived of their liberty or were deprived of rights or privileges of citizens of the United States.

125. Defendants' conspiracy was motivated by a desire to deprive Plaintiff of their civil rights or because of some racial, otherwise class-based, invidious, or discriminatory animus.

126. The Defendants that did not engage or participate in the conspiracy to interfere with Plaintiff's civil rights, had knowledge that acts in furtherance of the conspiracy were about to be committed or in process of being committed, possessed the power to prevent or aid in the prevention of the conspiratorial objective, and neglected to do so.

127. Accordingly, defendants violated Plaintiff rights, pursuant to the Fourth and Fourteenth Amendments to the Constitution of the United States.

128. Defendant City, as employer of the individual Defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

129. As a direct and proximate result of this unlawful conduct, Plaintiff sustained the damages hereinbefore alleged.

ELEVENTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Failure to Intervene Under New York State Law

130. The above paragraphs are hereby incorporated by reference as though fully set forth herein.

131. Those Defendants that were present but did not actively participate in the aforementioned unlawful conduct, observed such conduct, had an opportunity to prevent such conduct, had a duty to intervene and prevent such conduct, and failed to intervene.

132. Defendant City, as employer of the individual Defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

133. As a direct and proximate result of this unlawful conduct, Plaintiff sustained the damages hereinbefore alleged.

TWELFTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Failure to Intervene Under 42 U.S.C. § 1983 Against Individual Defendants

134. The above paragraphs are hereby incorporated by reference as though fully set forth herein.

135. Those Defendants that were present but did not actively participate in the aforementioned unlawful conduct observed such conduct, had an opportunity to prevent such conduct, had a duty to intervene and prevent such conduct, and failed to intervene.

136. Accordingly, the Defendants who failed to intervene violated the Fourth and Fourteenth Amendments.

137. As a direct and proximate result of this unlawful conduct, Plaintiff sustained the damages hereinbefore alleged.

THIRTEENTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Negligent Hiring, Training, Retention & Supervision Under New York State Law

138. The above paragraphs are hereby incorporated by reference as though fully set forth.

139. Defendant City owed a duty of care to Plaintiff to adequately hire, train, retain and supervise its employee defendants.

140. Defendant City breached those duties of care.

141. Defendant City placed defendants in a position where they could inflict foreseeable harm.

142. Defendant City knew or reasonably should have known of its employee defendants' propensity for violating the individual rights granted under the United States Constitution and the laws of the State of New York, prior to the injuries incurred by Plaintiff.

143. Defendant City failed to take reasonable measures in hiring, training, retaining and supervising its employee defendants that would have prevented the aforesaid injuries to Plaintiff.

144. As a direct and proximate result of this unlawful conduct, Plaintiff sustained the damages hereinbefore alleged.

FOURTEENTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Municipal "*Monell*" Liability Under 42 U.S.C. § 1983 Against Defendant City

145. The above paragraphs are hereby incorporated by reference as though fully set forth.

146. Defendant City maintained a policy or custom that caused Plaintiff to be deprived of their civil rights, tacitly approved of such violative conduct or was deliberately indifferent toward the potential exposure of individuals, such as Plaintiff, to such violative behavior.

147. Defendant City's employee police officers have engaged in an illegal pattern and practice of

misconduct, so consistent and widespread that it constitutes a custom or usage, of which a supervisor or policymaker must have been aware of.

148. Defendant City and its policymakers failed to provide adequate training or supervision to their subordinates to such an extent that is tantamount to a deliberate indifference toward the rights of those who may come into contact with Defendant City's employees.

149. Defendant City's employees engaged in such egregious and flagrant violations of Plaintiff's Constitutional rights that the need for enhanced training or supervision is obvious and equates to a display of deliberate indifference by Defendant City and its policymakers toward the rights of individuals, who may come into contact with Defendant City's employees.

150. Defendant City's repeated refusal or failure to install or apply corrective or preventive measures constitutes the tacit approval of such violative behavior or a deliberate indifference to the rights of those who may be affected by such behavior.

151. Defendant City's conduct caused the violation of Plaintiff civil rights, pursuant to Constitution of the United States.

152. As a direct and proximate result of this unlawful conduct, Plaintiff sustained the damages hereinbefore alleged.

WHEREFORE, Plaintiff respectfully request judgment against Defendants, jointly and severally, as follows:

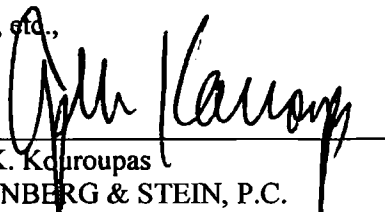
- a) In favor of Plaintiff in an amount to be determined by a jury for each of Plaintiff's causes of action;
- b) Awarding Plaintiff punitive damages in an amount to be determined by a jury;
- c) Awarding Plaintiff compensatory damages in an amount to be determined by a jury;
- d) Awarding Plaintiff reasonable attorney's fees and costs pursuant to 42 U.S.C. § 1988; and
- e) Granting such other and further relief as this Court deems just and proper.

JURY DEMAND

Plaintiff hereby demand a trial by jury.

Dated: New York, New York
January 03, 2023

Yours, etc.,



John K. Kouroupas
GREENBERG & STEIN, P.C.
Attorney for Plaintiff
DANTE STEPHENS
420 Lexington Avenue, Suite 2450
New York, New York 10170
(212) 681-2535
Our File No. 7138

TO:

CITY OF NEW YORK
100 Church Street
New York, NY 10007

JONATHAN VASQUEZ
POLICE OFFICER SHIELD NO.: 11731
4111 Laconia Ave,
Bronx, NY 10466

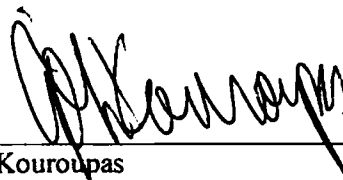
ATTORNEY'S VERIFICATION

JOHN K. KOUROUPAS, an attorney duly admitted to practice before the Courts of the State of New York, affirms the following to be true under the penalties of perjury:

I am an attorney at GREENBERG & STEIN, P.C., attorneys of record for Plaintiff, **DANTE STEPHENS**. I have read the annexed **SUMMONS AND VERIFIED COMPLAINT** and know the contents thereof, and the same are true to my knowledge, except those matters therein which are stated to be alleged upon information and belief, and as to those matters, I believe them to be true. My belief, as to those matters therein not stated upon knowledge, is based upon facts, records, and other pertinent information contained in my files.

This verification is made by me because Plaintiff is not presently in the county wherein, I maintain my offices.

DATED: New York, New York
January 03, 2023



John K. Kouropas
GREENBERG & STEIN, P.C.
Attorney for Plaintiff
DANTE STEPHENS
420 Lexington Avenue, Suite 2450
New York, New York 10170
(212) 681-2535

Index No.
SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK
COUNTY OF BRONX

DANTE STEPHENS,

Plaintiff,

-against-

CITY OF NEW YORK, JONATHAN VASQUEZ and JOHN
OR JANE DOES, "1-10", Individually and officially in their
capacities as police officers,

Defendants.

SUMMONS AND VERIFIED COMPLAINT

GREENBERG & STEIN, P.C.

Attorneys for Plaintiff

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TO: